Announcement of New JETRO Regional and Analysis Reports (October 15, 2026 Issue)

JETRO OCT 15 13:17

Subject: Announcement of New JETRO Regional and Analysis Reports (October 15, 2026 Issue)

Thank you for using JETRO Members Service.

We are pleased to deliver the latest information on JETRO's regional and analysis reports, which provide unique perspectives on political and economic trends in major countries and regions worldwide. We hope you will find these reports useful.

◆Contents◆----------

[Special Feature] Business Transformation Through Economic Security
Policy Measures and Partnerships Among Like-Minded Countries in Trade, Investment, and Technology

Countries and regions are implementing policy measures aimed at securing strategic autonomy and strategic indispensability from an economic security perspective. Examples include strengthening supply chains for strategic industries and critical materials, promoting domestic manufacturing returns, and advancing local production. Efforts to attract supply networks to domestic markets through subsidies and incentives are expanding. Additionally, collaboration among like-minded countries and the establishment of new frameworks are noteworthy developments. Meanwhile, stricter export controls and enhanced inbound and outbound investment screening are progressing, creating new risk factors for Japanese companies. This special feature reports on changes in trade, investment, and technology aspects brought about by economic security considerations to the local business environment.

<Special Feature Articles> ※Additional articles will be added.
◇U.S. Critical Minerals Trade Policy
◇Developments Among Countries Regarding Rare Earth Development in Africa
◇Saudi Arabia's AI and Data Center Industry (1) AI Ecosystem

[Special Feature] Universities Producing Highly Skilled Foreign Talent: At the Forefront
<Additional Article>

Japan's talent recruitment market has remained favorable for job seekers in recent years. The shortage of science and engineering personnel is particularly acute, prompting companies to focus on foreign talent. Meanwhile, approximately 70% of domestic international students are in humanities majors, resulting in limited science and engineering talent. Against this backdrop, interest is growing in international students

pursuing science and engineering majors taught in English and science and engineering personnel enrolled in overseas universities. Additionally, companies are increasingly seeking to hire overseas university students studying Japanese, regardless of their major. This special feature presents characteristic curricula, employment status at Japanese companies, and messages to companies based on interviews with promising domestic and overseas universities that produce science and engineering talent and Japanese language learners interested in employment in Japan.

<Additional Article>
◇Engineering Talent Cultivated Through Industry-Academia Collaboration and Expanding Japanese Language Education: RMK Engineering College, India

---

[Special Feature] Diversifying Consumer Profiles in Asia-Pacific
—Deciphering Values, Lifestyles, and Market Opportunities— <Additional Article>

The Asia-Pacific region is experiencing diversification in consumer needs and purchasing behavior driven by rising incomes, advancing urbanization, and digitalization. While these changes differ by country, common trends are also evident. This special feature examines market trends in major ASEAN countries, India, and Bangladesh, analyzing what consumers value, their consumption characteristics, and factors determining purchasing decisions, alongside case studies of Japanese companies operating locally. By cross-examining cases across countries and sectors, we seek market opportunities and business development insights for Japanese companies.

<Additional Articles>
◇Indonesia (1) 280 Million Market: Consumers Choosing by Price and Value
◇Vietnam (1) Vietnamese Consumer Market: Maturing Consumer Profile and Digital Consumption
◇Vietnam (2) Expansion and Diversification of Vietnam's E-Commerce Market
◇Vietnam (3) Health and Beauty Consumption Becoming Routine in Vietnam
◇Vietnam (4) Urban Development Through Commerce, Education, and Real Estate (Toshin Development)

[Special Feature] Business Cases in Africa <Additional Article>

Africa offers diverse business opportunities not only for large enterprises with networks and capital but also for startups with cutting-edge technology and small and medium-sized enterprises across various sectors. Moreover, diverse approaches are possible in each country, such as partnerships with established third-country companies and local enterprises. This special feature has introduced concrete business cases in Africa during fiscal years 2024 and 2025, including developments surrounding the 9th Tokyo International Conference on African Development (TICAD9). In fiscal 2026, with an eye

toward the next TICAD10, we will feature a wide range of business cases from Japanese and local enterprises, primarily through company interviews, exploring new business opportunities, cooperation possibilities, and business development strategies emerging locally.

<Additional Articles>

■Africa Expansion from Throughout Japan

◇SAISAN Engaged in Last-Mile LPG Supply in Rwanda